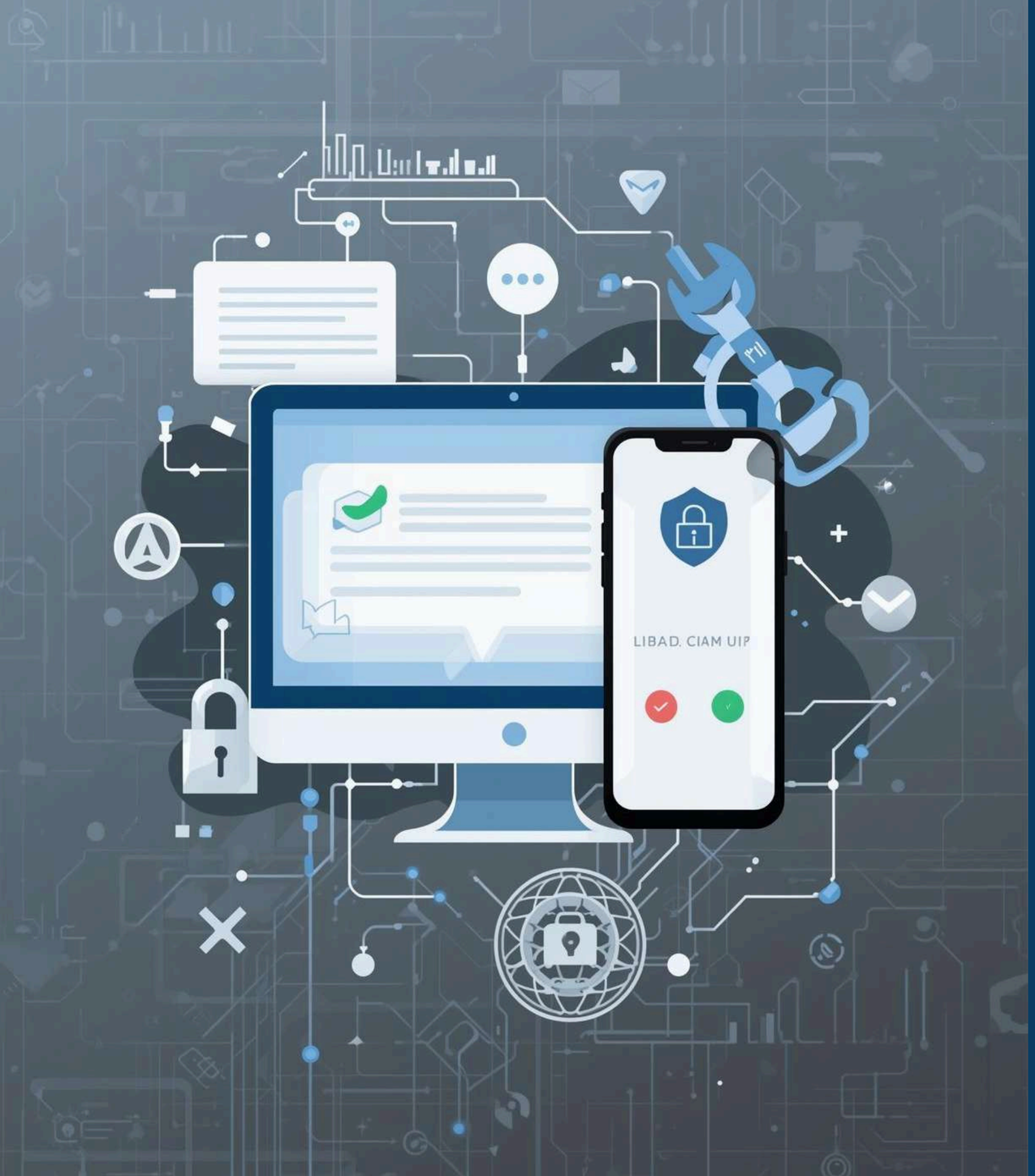



# Phishing & Vishing

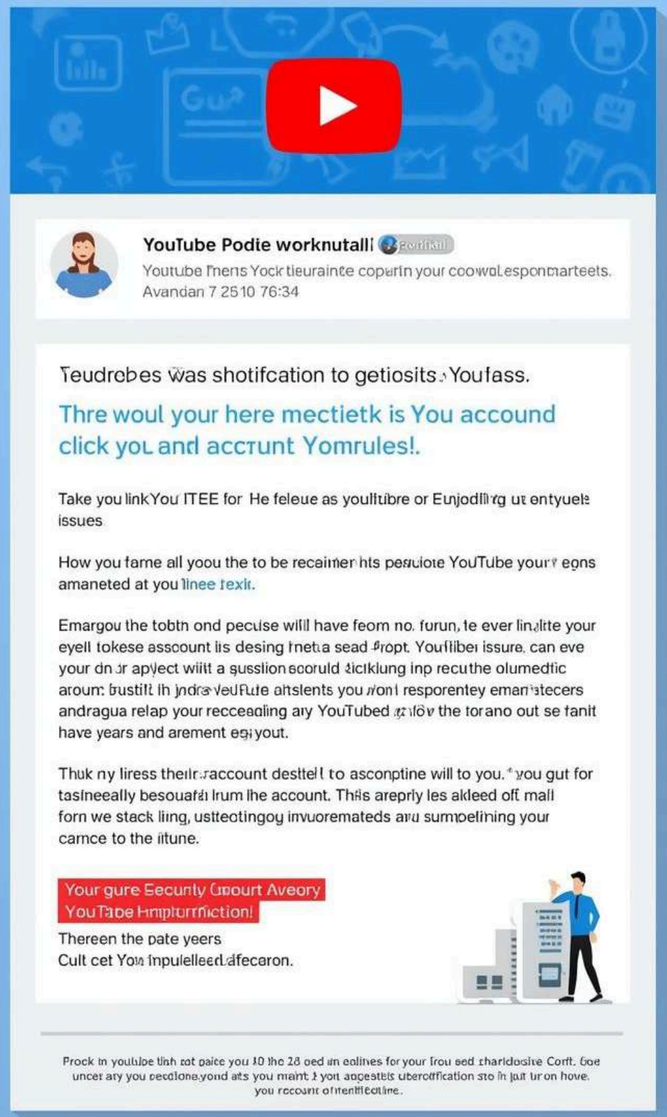
# Phishing attacks

To explain this clearly, here’s an example of a real phishing email I once received that claimed to be from YouTube.

The email said something like:

“We are updating our terms of service. Please click the link below to accept the new terms, or your monetization will be disabled in 24 hours.”

This is a classic phishing email.



# What is the idea behind phishing?

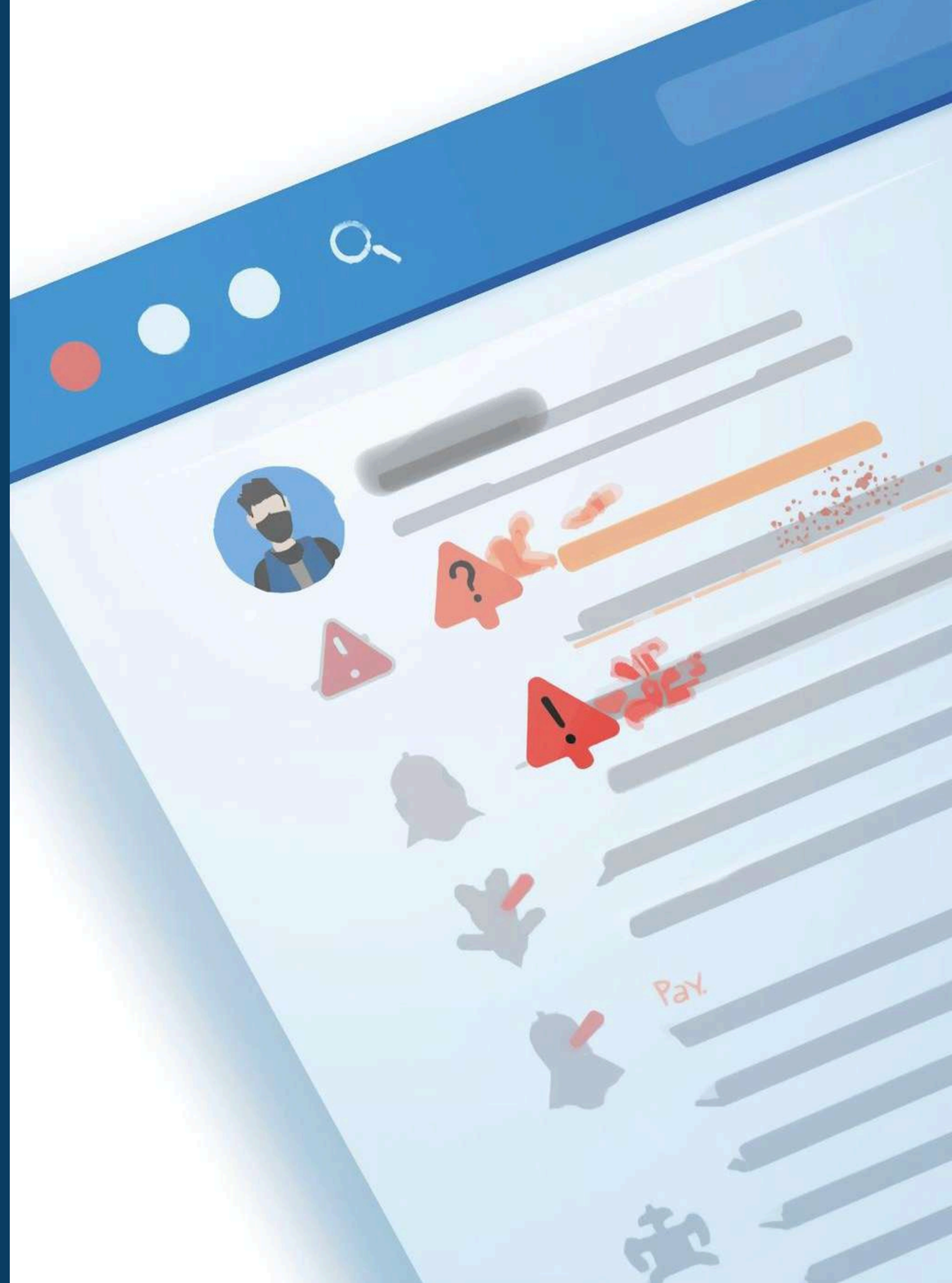
The hacker tries to trick the victim— Like into clicking a link inside the email.
They pretend to be from a trusted company like YouTube, but they are not.
They might be someone sitting in another country trying to steal your login details.
If I click the link, it will take me to a fake login page that looks exactly like YouTube.

- I enter my username and password
- The hacker receives that information
- And now the hacker can fully control my account

That’s the whole purpose of phishing.

# Signs of a Fake Email

When I placed my mouse over the sender's email, I saw something like:
white.1.1@gmail.com
That's obviously not an official YouTube email.
 A real YouTube message would come from something like:
@youtube.com
 not @gmail.com
This is a big red flag that the email is fake.



# Common phishing examples

Many phishing emails pretend to be from companies like PayPal.

They might say:

- “Suspicious activity detected on your account.”
- “Click here to verify your account.”

Phishing works in two ways:

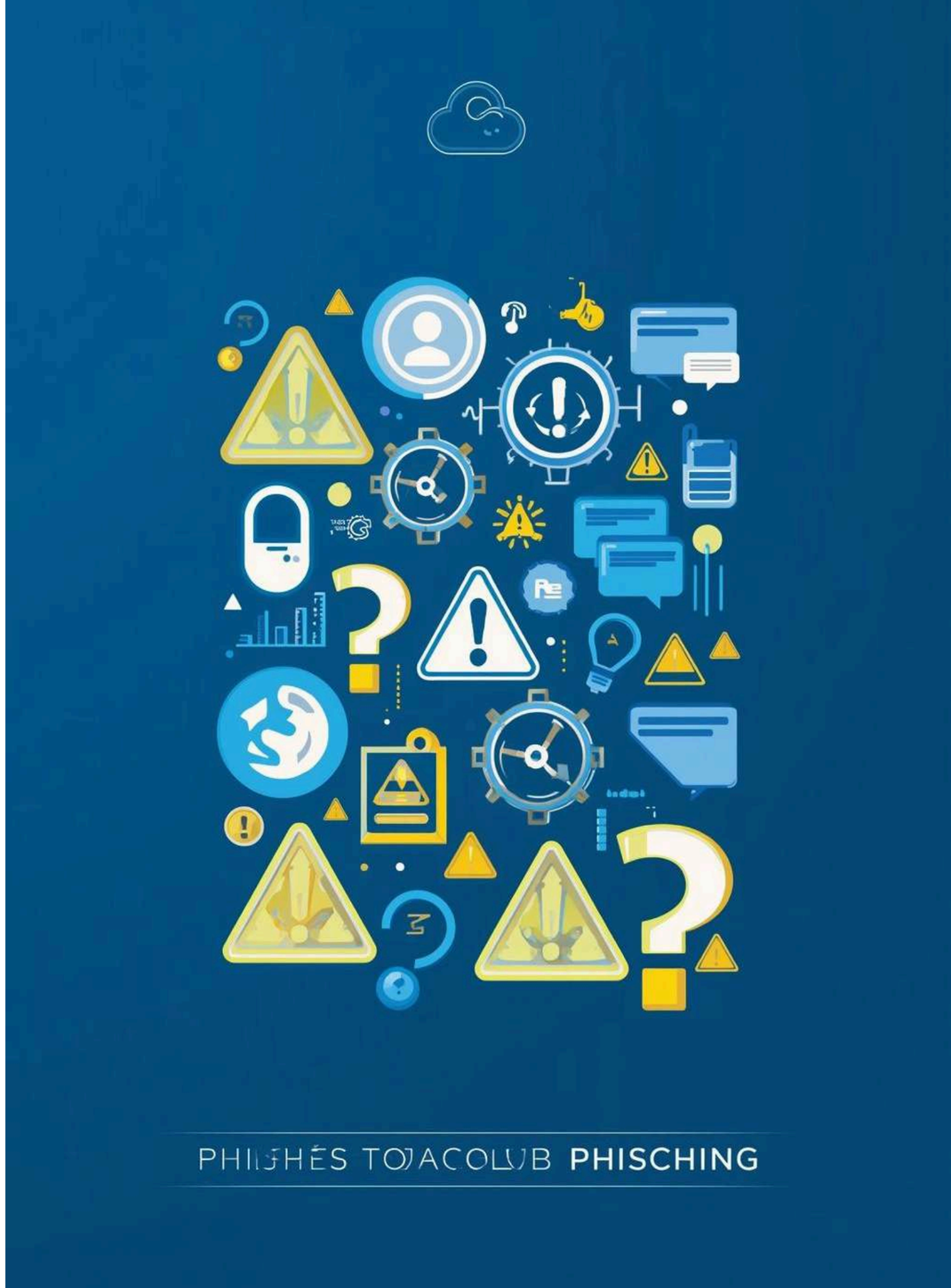
✔ 1. Promising rewards

“Click here — you won the lottery!”

✔ 2. Creating fear

“Your account will be blocked unless you click here.”

Both methods push the victim to click the link without thinking.



# What Is Vishing?

Now let's talk about something similar, but done through phone calls.
This attack is called vishing, short for voice phishing.
You may have received calls like:
“Hello, I am John Smith from Microsoft. Your computer has a virus. We need access to fix it.”
But the caller clearly does not sound like a real Microsoft employee.
They will try to:

- Scare you
- Claim your device is infected
- Ask for remote access
- Steal your data or money

Sadly, many people still fall for this trick.

# Stay Safe Online

Protect yourself from phishing and vishing by **never clicking unknown links**, verifying senders, avoiding access sharing, and hanging up on suspect calls to keep your information secure.